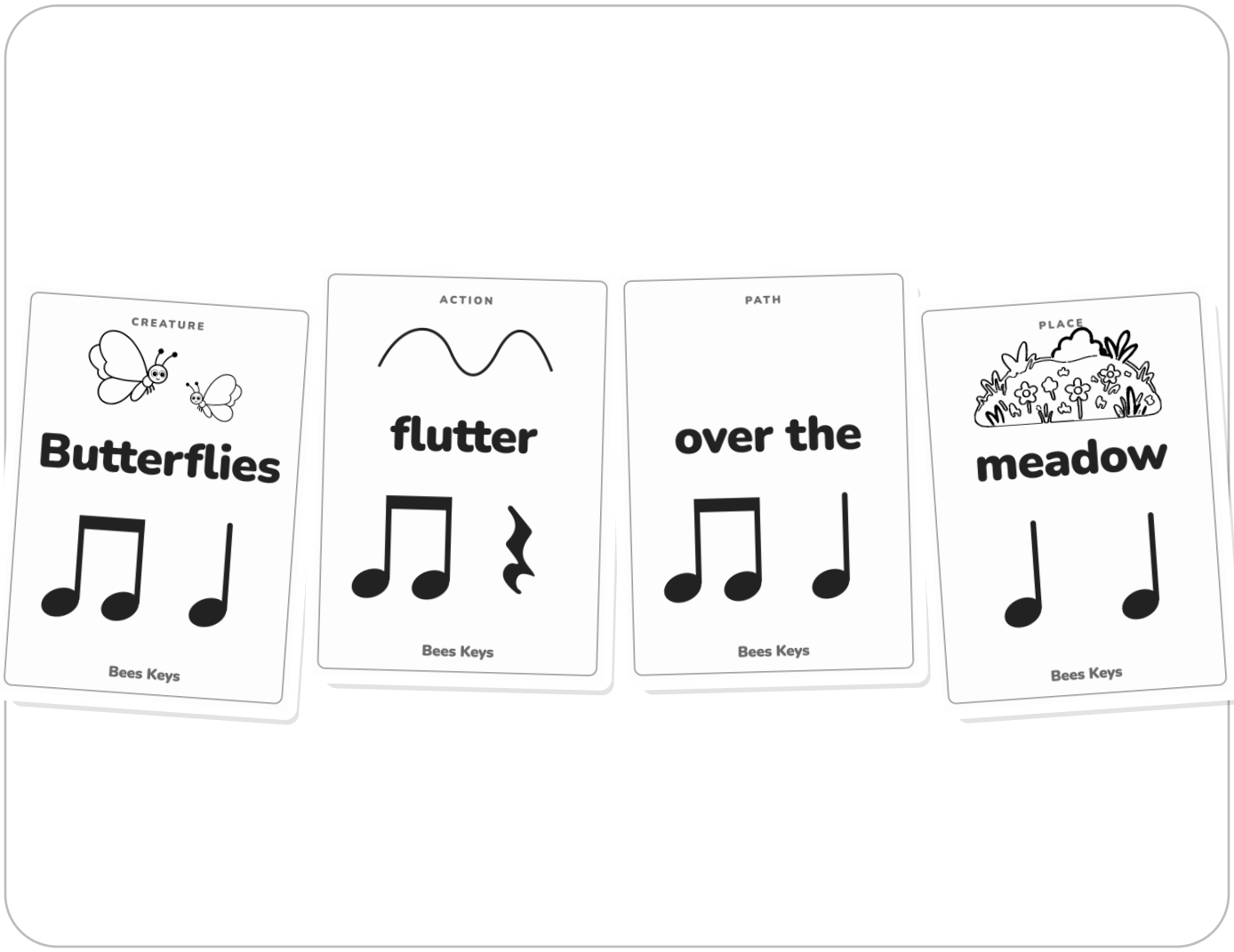
Rhythm Phrase Builders

PRINTER-FRIENDLY • COLOR YOUR OWN



Build a phrase, read the sentence, and clap the rhythm with 36 mix-and-match cards

Includes an ideas sheet, 4 decks of 9 cards, a phrase mat, and a write-the-rhythm page

BEES KEYS

Learn the piano key names through play

These cards are about rhythm: say it, clap it, play it. Naming the keys is the other half of a first lesson, and that is the whole job of Bees Keys: a bee flies across the screen carrying a note name, and your student taps the matching key before it escapes. Free, with no ads, and Bees Keys Pro is a one-time unlock that adds play on your own piano, by mic or MIDI.

Scan to get Bees Keys

On the App Store and Google Play · beeskeysapp.com

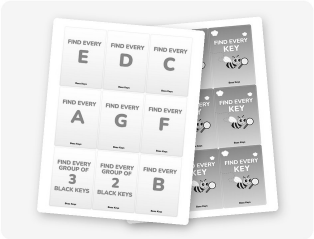
GET BEES KEYS

MORE FREE PRINTABLES

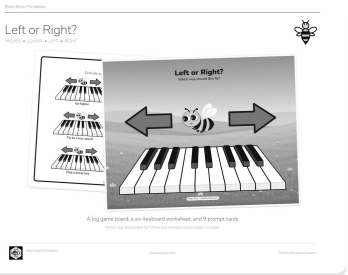
More on the site, with new ones every few weeks



Bee's Sound Garden



Find Every Key



Left or Right?

Want them first? Join the list.

Scan and it opens a ready-made email. Send it and you are on the list.
Your address is only ever used to send you the free resources.

SEND ME NEW FREEBIES

Bees Keys

RHYTHM PHRASE BUILDERS

Lay one card from each pile in order, **Creature**, **Action**, **Path**, **Place**. Read the sentence, then chant and clap the rhythm underneath.



CREATURE · ACTION · PATH · PLACE

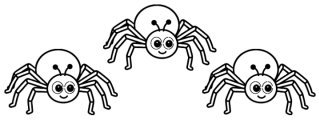
IDEAS FOR USE

1. Mix and match cards to build rhythmic phrases!
2. Clap along to the rhythm as you chant the words.
3. Choose a 5-finger scale, and make up a melody to go with your new Rhythm Phrase!
4. For more advanced students, try to improvise a melody over a I–IV–V–I chord progression, with one chord per card.

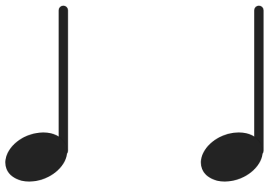
MORE IDEAS

5. **Build a silly sentence:** Mix the cards randomly, then chant and clap whatever funny phrase you create.
6. **Echo game:** Teacher claps or plays a phrase, and the student finds the cards that match what they heard.
7. **Rhythm dictation:** Build a phrase, hide the cards, then have the student notate the rhythm from memory.
8. **Make it move:** March, tap, stomp, bounce, or jump the rhythm while chanting the words.
9. **One-note improv:** Play the whole rhythm on one piano key first, then gradually add more notes.
10. **Question and answer:** Build two phrases. Play the first as a musical question and the second as the answer.
11. **Rhythm matching:** Find two different cards that use the same rhythm.
12. **Make a longer piece:** Build 2, 4, or 8 phrases, then arrange them into a larger composition.

CREATURE

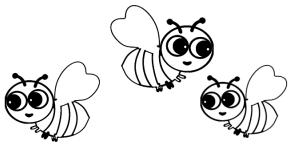


Spiders

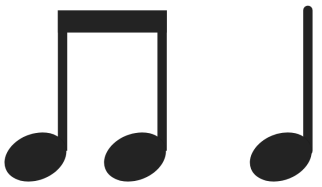


Bees Keys

CREATURE

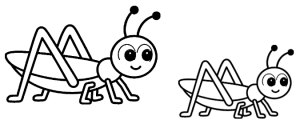


Bumblebees



Bees Keys

CREATURE

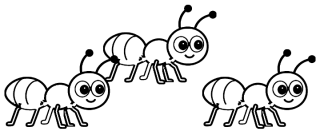


Grasshoppers

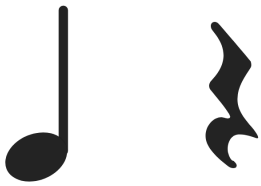


Bees Keys

CREATURE

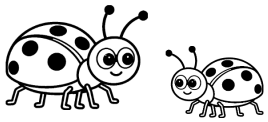


Ants



Bees Keys

CREATURE

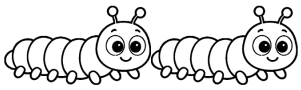


Ladybugs

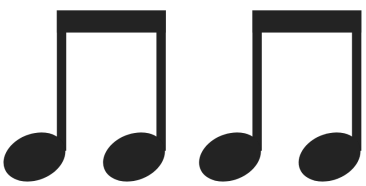


Bees Keys

CREATURE

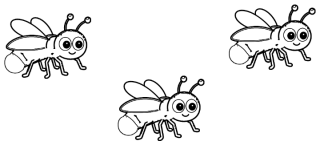


Caterpillars

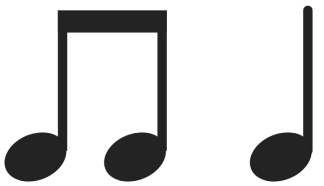


Bees Keys

CREATURE

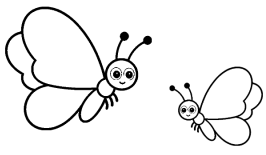


Fireflies



Bees Keys

CREATURE

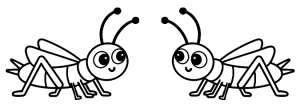


Butterflies

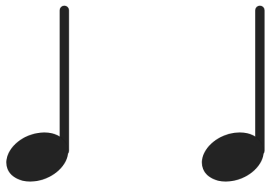


Bees Keys

CREATURE



Crickets



Bees Keys

ACTION



flutter



Bees Keys

ACTION



crawl

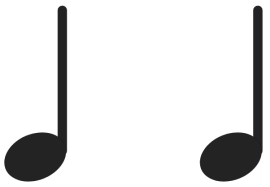


Bees Keys

ACTION



hover

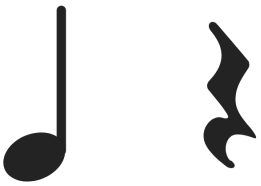


Bees Keys

ACTION



jump



Bees Keys

ACTION



march



Bees Keys

ACTION



scurry

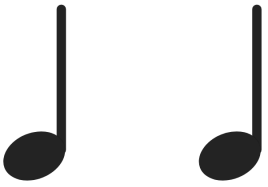


Bees Keys

ACTION



glitter

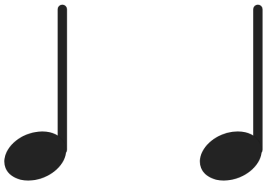


Bees Keys

ACTION



wiggle



Bees Keys

ACTION



dance



Bees Keys

PATH

over the



Bees Keys

PATH

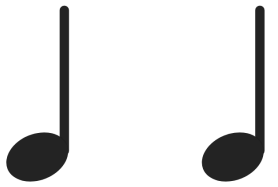
under the



Bees Keys

PATH

through the



Bees Keys

PATH

across the



Bees Keys

PATH

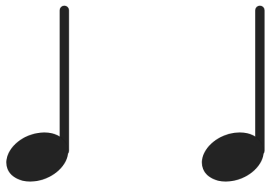
around the



Bees Keys

PATH

near the



Bees Keys

PATH

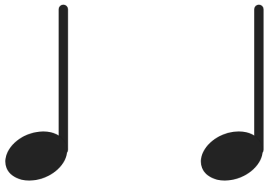
beside the



Bees Keys

PATH

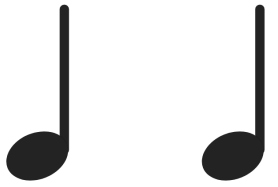
on the



Bees Keys

PATH

in the

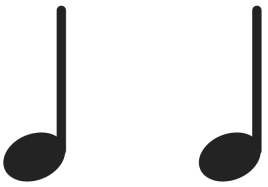


Bees Keys

PLACE



meadow

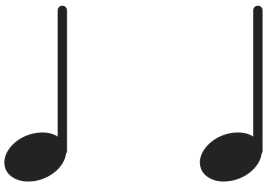


Bees Keys

PLACE



garden

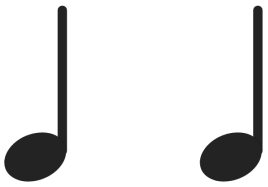


Bees Keys

PLACE



flowers



Bees Keys

PLACE



grass



Bees Keys

PLACE



leaves



Bees Keys

PLACE



woods



Bees Keys

PLACE



pond



Bees Keys

PLACE



trail



Bees Keys

PLACE



ground



Bees Keys

Bees Keys

RHYTHM PHRASE BUILDERS

Name _____ Date _____

CREATURE	ACTION	PATH	PLACE
PLACE CARD HERE	PLACE CARD HERE	PLACE CARD HERE	PLACE CARD HERE

WRITE THE RHYTHM

WRITE THE RHYTHM

Bees Keys

RHYTHM PHRASE BUILDERS

Name _____ Date _____

CREATURE	ACTION	PATH	PLACE
WRITE THE RHYTHM			
WRITE THE RHYTHM			
WRITE THE RHYTHM			
WRITE THE RHYTHM			